

The One Percent Per Week TQQQ Trading Strategy:

A Walk-Forward

by: Guy R. Fleury

I first published the results of my version of the **One Percent Per Week** (OPPW) trading strategy in early May 2024.¹ We can compare how it performed then to now, showing how it did over the last year. It is the same process as a walk-forward, where you let your program run as if trading live on data it has never seen before.

My program makes one trade every week with no consideration of market conditions whatsoever.

Since last year, the strategy has added 57 new trades and had a 56.5% compounded annual growth rate (CAGR). We could consider those 57 weeks as a walk-forward period since the program remained unchanged and unaware of its future outcomes.

I changed the original version's trading philosophy. Instead of seeking a 1% discount from the open before taking a trade, I went directly to buy at whatever the price at the open on the first trading day of the week. Overall, the trading rules remained simple. I also changed the strategy's profit target from 1% to a minimum of 7% due to the higher TQQQ volatility. If the price reaches its profit target, the program's sell-limit order triggers, cashing in the profit.

If the price shows some weakness, meaning TQQQ closes below its entry price, a sell limit order is issued the next day at the opening price to break even. Otherwise, it will take the lesser profit or loss on Friday's close. These are trading rules you can do by hand on a cellphone from anywhere.

The new trading philosophy is that if you see any price weakness, you choose to run away by removing your bet from the table as a protection measure. It became the most critical element of the strategy.

Playing chicken turned out to be highly profitable.

Approximately half of the trades (~51%) would generate profits, while the rest would suffer losses. Nonetheless, overall, the strategy would still win the game, even with odds of nearly 50/50.

You didn't need any outside help to implement this strategy. Moreover, the simulations confirmed that you could execute this strategy as a discretionary trading method if you wanted to. It would take 5 minutes or less a week to do by hand.

¹ A stock trading program that originated on Wealth-Lab as part of their published examples.

PRIOR KNOWLEDGE

You should have known that the strategy would work from the start had you been there.

In 2010, you had over 10 years of QQQ data to make up your mind. You knew that TQQQ would try to leverage 3 times QQQ's daily return. All that was required was for QQQ to continue rising. That is equivalent to saying the market average will increase in the future.

I recall market gurus predicting dire scenarios due to the inherent return degradation a 3x-leveraged stock would have to endure, especially if traded repeatedly. And their best scenario was to short the thing to oblivion due to its expected and continuous decline. I have addressed this in prior articles.²

You could also design your trading strategy, especially leveraged ones, with over-compensation in mind. The method used to over-compensate is unimportant, but the impact will be visible. The OPPW strategy incorporates overcompensation as part of its portfolio equation.

*Taking a position every first trading day of the week
was not a difficult decision to make.
That decision is even easier today.*

You now have 25 years of data history on QQQ and over 15 years on TQQQ. Yes, a 3x-leveraged ETF will fluctuate 3x more than the ETF on which it is based.

*It is why **you play the game:**
to capture price variations.
No price variations mean no potential gains.
Low returns also lead to low profits.*

We often find articles stating that, in the long run, all trading strategies fail (see, for instance, Marcos López de Prado's excellent papers on the subject).

Often, we have strategies that fail going forward due to unsolved inherent problems (such as return degradation, for instance)³.

We can identify, after the fact, faults such as over-fitting, survivorship biases, poor strategy design, or excessive emphasis on anomalies that may not repeat. But we are the ones designing these trading strategies. Why did we not consider those known potential flaws in the design process?

² See my 2014 paper **Fix Fraction** showing how to compensate for the return degradation.

³ Any strategy with equal profit targets and stop-losses will degrade over time.

Some of this knowledge will only become apparent after a certain amount of time has passed or you have ensured that your strategy design will endure. If, nonetheless, a trading strategy blows up in our face, which frequently happens, we will be the ones paying the price for having given time and money to such trading programs.

We are still the ones to decide whether to use those trading programs or not. Stating that we might not have done our homework and should have looked more profoundly into the inner workings of those trading procedures.

*The **One Percent Per Week** strategy in its current state
is not over-fitted (because it cannot be),
has no survivorship biases (since it cannot have any),
and this, by construction.*

The OPPW strategy uses no technical indicators or fundamental data, not even the phases of the Moon or tarot cards.

Plain and simple, in its current iteration, it trades every first trading day of the week. It will eat weekly volatility, profit from it, or suffer from it.

My version of the OPPW strategy has not changed since it was presented in May 2024, over a year ago. Its most critical portfolio metric averages have not changed much, either.

MY OPPW STRATEGY

Table #1 below compares the portfolio metrics of the June 2025 simulation with the one in May 2024. The **Overall Profit** is of primary concern with it \$36 million in added profits over the last year.

Table #1 shows how some metric averages had only minor deviations. The average metrics of 2024 were expected to continue, as stated as early as in [Part I](#), the first article in the series of 29 articles on the OPPW strategy. Each of the articles elaborates on different aspects of the strategy, addressing the most relevant questions.

The average profit percent per trade remained at 1.02% despite a higher number of losing trades than winning ones. At its worst during the year, it was down to a 1.00% profit per trade (per week). The change was not significant enough to say that the strategy changed its behavior over the year.

Table #1: Comparing OPPW Performance - June 2025 to May 2024

Portfolio Metric	June 2025	May 2024	Variation	Percent	Notes
Starting Capital	\$100,000	\$100,000	—	—	
Number of Trades	799	742	57 weeks		
Years Invested	15.365	14.269	1.096 years		
Overall Profit	\$95,214,560	\$59,176,233	+\$36,038,327	+60.9%	1
Profit %	95,214%	59,176%			
Profit Per Bar	15.57	15.18	0.39		
APR (CAGR)	56.50%	56.66%	-0.16%	-0.28%	2
Avg Profit % Per Trade	1.02%	1.02%	—		
Exposure	51.40%	50.97%	+0.43%		
Max Drawdown	-54.86%	-54.47%	+0.49%		
Profitable Positions	407	380	+27		3
% Profitable	50.94%	51.21%	-0.27%		
Avg Profit %	4.60%	4.54%	+0.06%		4
Unprofitable Positions	392	362	+30		
% Unprofitable	49.06%	48.79%	+0.27%		
Avg % Loss	-2.70%	-2.68%	+0.02%		5
Sharpe Ratio	1.26	1.26	—		6
Benchmark Used	QQQ	SPY			
Benchmark Result	\$1,129,443	\$377,616			7
Benchmark CAGR	17.80%	11.62%			

Notes:

1- The early May 2024 results were published as Figure #2 in **Part II** of the **One Percent Per Week** series of articles. You have a copy in Figure #1 below.

2- The **APR** (a.k.a.: CAGR), with slightly more than a year of trading, stayed about the same. In a randomly evolving game, we cannot consider a 0.16% difference as significant on 56.66%. We can easily say that the strategy maintained its high CAGR level, which was the primary objective of the game in the first place.

3- The strategy added 57 trades after May 2024, with 27 of them being profitable. It can explain the slight decrease in the **% profitable** since we do have 30 negative trades. Nonetheless, the strategy generated more profits.

4- From May 2024 to June 2025, the **Avg Profit %** stayed about the same. Again, there is a non-significant variation of 0.06%. We can confidently state that the average profit percentage per winning trade remained unchanged over the additional 57 trades, spanning slightly more than a year of trading.

5- The average percent loss per losing trade also remained at about the same level. The increase of 0.02% can explain the impact of the added 30 negative trades compared to the 27 positive trades.

6- Regardless of the added 57 trades, the Sharpe ratio remained the same at 1.26. Implying that the nature of the trading strategy had not changed. You were still paying the same premium for an expected return.

7- The benchmarks used were not the same for both simulations. It allows comparison between them. QQQ outperformed SPY over the period, even reaching a 17.8% CAGR. Compare QQQ's results to the June TQQQ's overall profit. The OPPW strategy generated 84 times more than holding QQQ. And not just 3 times, as might have been implied by the 3x-leveraged TQQQ scenario. The 3x leverage is applied to the return and not to the final portfolio value.

The simulation screenshots in Figure #1 are the source of the portfolio metrics used in Table #1.

Figure #1: OPPW June 2025 Simulation vs May 2024.

Simulation: June 2025				Simulation: May 2024			
Metrics Report		Equity Curve		Metrics Report		Equity Curve	
Select ScoreCard:	Basic ScoreCard	Strategy	Benchmark (Q...	Select ScoreCard:	Basic ScoreCard	Strategy	Benchmark (SPY)
Summary Starting Capital 100,000.00 100,000.00 Profit 95,214,560.82 1,129,443.05 Profit % 95,214.56% 1,129.44% Profit Per Bar 15.57 14.66 APR 56.50% 17.80% Std Dev of Annual Ret... 154.75% 20.68% Exposure 51.40% 99.99% Maximum Exposure 99.91% 100.00% EAR 109.93% 17.80% Alpha (α) 33.92 - Beta (β) 1.29 - Sharpe Ratio 1.26 0.95 Sortino Ratio 2.11 1.56 WL Score 49.62 11.46 Slope of Equity Curve 19,282.86 264.81				Summary Starting Capital 100,000.00 100,000.00 Profit 99,176,233.23 377,616.20 Profit % 99,176.23% 377.62% Profit Per Bar 15.18 5.28 APR 56.66% 11.62% Std Dev of Annual Ret... 165.01% 13.52% Exposure 50.97% 99.96% Maximum Exposure 99.91% 99.99% Alpha (α) 40.23 - Beta (β) 1.46 - Sharpe Ratio 1.26 0.73 Sortino Ratio 2.15 1.09 WL Score 50.61 7.66 Slope of Equity Curve 11,506.55 97.32			
Positions Position Count 799 1 Avg Profit 119,167.16 1,129,443.05 Avg Profit % 1.02% 1,129.77% Profit Factor 1.44 - Payoff Ratio 1.70 - Avg Bars Held 3.27 3,853.00 Avg Trades Per Month 8.64 0.01 Avg Bars Held as % of... 0.08 99.97 Largest Bars Held as %... 0.13 99.97 NSF Position Count 0 0 NSF Ratio 0.00 0.00				Positions Position Count 742 1 Avg Profit 79,752.34 377,616.20 Avg Profit % 1.02% 377.89% Profit Factor 1.64 - Payoff Ratio 1.70 - Avg Bars Held 3.35 3,580.00 Avg Trades Per Month 8.63 0.01 Avg Bars Held as % of... 0.09 99.97 Largest Bars Held as %... 0.14 99.97 NSF Position Count 0 0 NSF Ratio 0.00 0.00			
Drawdown Max Drawdown -35,133,550.71 -333,824.80 Max Drawdown Date 3/28/2025 12/28/2022 Max Drawdown % -34.96% -35.62% Max Drawdown % Date 7/6/2010 12/28/2022 Recovery Factor 2.71 3.38				Drawdown Max Drawdown -22,726,223.93 -113,154.10 Max Drawdown Date 10/26/2023 10/12/2022 Max Drawdown % -25.51% -34.10% Max Drawdown % Date 7/6/2010 3/23/2020 Recovery Factor 2.60 3.34			
Profitable Positions Count 407 1 Max Consecutive 9 1 % Profitable 50.94% 100.00% Avg Profit 768,565.24 1,129,443.05 Avg Profit % 4.60% 1,129.77% Average Bars Held 3.01 3,853.00				Profitable Positions Count 380 1 % Profitable 51.21% 100.00% Avg Profit 399,515.94 377,616.20 Avg Profit % 4.54% 377.89% Average Bars Held 3.02 3,580.00			
Unprofitable Positions Count 392 0 Max Consecutive 15 0 % Unprofitable 49.06% 0.00% Avg Loss -555,080.34 - Avg Loss % -2.70% - Avg Bars Held 3.53 -				Unprofitable Positions Count 362 0 % Unprofitable 48.79% 0.00% Avg Loss -255,911.11 - Avg Loss % -2.68% - Avg Bars Held 3.70 -			
Interest, Commission... Commission Paid 0.00 0.00 Cash Interest Received 0.00 0.00 Margin Interest Paid -0.00 -0.00 Maximum Margin Used 1.00 1.00 Dividends Received 0.00 0.00 Total Currency Adj 0.00 0.00							

([Click here to enlarge](#))

From May 2024 on, the strategy was unaware of its future, except that it would take a position on the first trading day of every week. The exits were determined by TQQQ's price behavior over the week. If the weekly volatility was enough to trigger the profit target, the position was closed, and from there, the strategy would wait until the following week.

The strategy's exposure rate was 51.4% for the June 2025 simulation, compared to 50.97% for the May 2024 simulation. Again, it is a measure that exhibits insufficient change to be considered relevant. Just the randomness of those 57 new trades could have pushed those outcomes much further apart.

With an exposure rate of nearly 50%, the OPPW strategy still maintained its 56% CAGR over those 15+ years. There must be at least one reason for this to happen, if not more.

By taking a position, the strategy acts as if playing a game where you first have to put your bet on the table with no prior knowledge of the odds of finishing the week with a profit. Your bet will win or lose, but you do not know in advance which will happen.

We have from Table #1, the % **profitable** trades at 50.94%. It is so close to 50/50 odds that we would be hard-pressed not to declare it even odds. Nonetheless, there is a slight upward bias in the market as a whole, resulting in having more up than down weeks. However, over the last year, this was not the case since we had 27 winning trades compared to 30 trades that finished with losses.

Surprisingly or not, the strategy made money, and even more surprising might be that the portfolio increased by 60.9%. Based on the portfolio metrics, there was practically no change. So, where is the money coming from? What is generating those profits?

The answer to the questions above has already been provided, and from the beginning of this series of articles on the OPPW strategy. The profits mostly come from Type-C trades.

Type-C trades do not generate any profits on their own. They simply do not destroy the outcome of Type-B trades.

The Type-C trade is a break-even stop-loss. It comes into play as soon as the strategy detects price weakness, which is easily determined. If the price closes the day below the entry price, a sell limit order is issued the next day at the entry price to break even. Nothing complicated. It might be the beauty and simplicity of this trading strategy: its ability to let go and wait for the next trade.

MY PORTFOLIO EQUATION

We can use the portfolio equations presented in prior articles to describe these two scenarios. We would get, using the simulation's portfolio metrics, within the potential rounding on the third decimal, something like the following.

For the June 2025 simulation:

$$0.5140 \cdot 100000 \cdot (1 + 0.04589)^{407} \cdot (1 - 0.0270)^{392} = \$95,940,688$$

And for the May 2024 scenario:

$$0.5097 \cdot 100000 \cdot (1 + 0.04541)^{380} \cdot (1 - 0.0269)^{362} = \$59,117,542$$

The trading procedures remained unchanged. From the May 2024 scenario, we added 57 trades over the last year (27 wins and 30 losses).

Using the June 2025 equation, we can project for next year by adding 52 trades, using approximately the same average trade distribution.

Going for 27 positive trades (51.92% of added trades) and 25 negative ones (48.08%) with about the same average percent win and loss per trade.

The expected outcome with the added trades would give:

$$0.5140 \cdot 100000 \cdot (1 + 0.04589)^{407+27} \cdot (1 - 0.0270)^{392+25} = \$162,534,710$$

giving a 69.4% expected return for the added year. Even with a 51.92% hit rate. Overall, it would still maintain the running CAGR at 57.11%. A little higher than the previous year, which was also expected. Again, maintaining its slow-rising CAGR.

The June 2026 estimate is, in fact, just that: an estimate. It won't be until next year that I will know how close it was to what happened. Even a $\pm 10\%$ deviation from that estimate would not be that bad, especially a positive overshoot.

The strategy's objective remains to maintain an average profit per trade of 1% over the 851 trades. The strategy was able to maintain a 1% profit per trade over the last 799 weeks (15.365 years).

This places further emphasis on Type-C trades, the break-even stop-loss, and the merit of average long-term portfolio metrics. Simple trading rules can make you win the game. Numerous variations on this strategy's theme can be derived. Study the strategy, improve it, and make it your own.

A trading strategy simulation can reveal what it has done in the past; it can also indicate what it might do in the future.

Related Papers and Articles:

The One Percent Per Week TQQQ Trading Strategy: FINANCING THE OPPW
The One Percent Per Week TQQQ Trading Strategy: THE GAME YOU WILL WIN
The One Percent Per Week TQQQ Trading Strategy: THE EXPECTED UNEXPECTED
The One Percent Per Week TQQQ Trading Program: Making Improvements, and Part II
The One Percent Per Week TQQQ Trading Strategy: MY EQUATION

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